

▽ Battle of Manzikert



1071

BATTLE OF MANZIKERT

Responding to continual Seljuq raids on the frontiers of his empire, Byzantine Emperor Romanus IV Diogenes marched his army into eastern Anatolia. Caught by surprise by a large Turkish force, Romanus was captured and his army destroyed, opening the way for the permanent Seljuq conquest of much of Asia Minor.

“My punishment is far heavier.
I forgive you, and set you free.”

SULTAN ALP ARSLAN TO ROMANUS DIOGENES
AFTER MANZIKERT, 1071

1075 **Pope Gregory**

VII issues a decree
forbidding lay
investiture

1079

1077 **The Seljuk
sultanate of Rum**
is established
in Asia Minor



△ The Bayeux Tapestry, panel depicting the death of King Harold

1077

HOLY ROMAN EMPEROR HENRY IV PERFORMS PENANCE

Henry IV argued with Pope Gregory VII over the right of secular rulers to appoint bishops, which the pope disputed. In response, Gregory excommunicated Henry in 1076, so freeing Henry's nobles from their oaths of loyalty and causing them to revolt. Henry performed a humiliating penance, at Canossa, Italy, waiting for three days in a storm for the pope to revoke his excommunication.

▷ Emperor Henry IV's penance

